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Test: The 1916 Rising

Section 1: Keywords Match the correct key word with the right definition in the grid below

A. IRB	1. Prison in Wales where 3,000 irish rebels were imprisoned after the 1916 Rising
B. Patrick Pearse	2. Women's branch of the Irish Volunteers
C. Blood sacrifice	3. Rebel leader who went to Germany to get arms and ammunition
D. Proclamation	4. Famous battle at a city bridge where 13 rebels held up 1750 British soldiers
E. GPO	5. Jail where 15 rebel leaders were imprisoned and shot.
F. Roger Casement	6. Leader of the 1916 Rebellion
G. The Helga	7. Declaration of Independence read out by P Pearse on the steps of the GPO
H. Countess MacKievicz	8. A republican organisation aiming to get independence for Ireland also called The Fenians.
I. Cumann Na mBan	9. Pearse's idea of dying for your country to achieve independence
J. Mount Street Bridge	10. Head Quarters for the Rising
K. General Lowe	11. Female IRB commander in charge of St Stephen's Green during the 1916 Rising
L. Elizabeth O' Farrell	12. British gunboat that sailed up the River Liffey and Shelled the GPO
M. Kilmainham Jail	13. Head Quarters of the rebellion
N. Martial Law	14. Woman who gave the surrender letter from Patrick Pearse to General Lowe
O. Frognock Prison	15. British General in charge of supressing the 1916 Rising

1-30

2-38

3-30

98%

A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L	M	N	O
8	6	9	7	10	3	12	11	2	4	15	14	5	13	1

Section 2: Document

The following two sources relate to the Easter Rising which started on Monday 24th April, 1916. Study the sources and answer the questions which follow.

Source 1: an account by a member of the Irish Volunteers who was in the GPO (General Post Office) during the Easter Rising.

On Thursday, the enemy started to shell the GPO, but there was no direct hit throughout the day. The heat from burning buildings opposite was so great that men had to keep the window fortifications drenched with water to prevent the sandbags and sacks from going on fire. The men were stained with soot, scalded by steam and scorched by the fire.

About noon, on Friday, the first shell struck the GPO. The fire it started was quickly got under control. About 3 p.m. shells began to pour into the building and fires broke out in various sections. Towards dusk, the building was alight in every quarter and the front portion was a roaring furnace. Our position had become impossible. The evacuation began from the Henry Street side door.

Source 2: a photograph of the GPO after the Rising had ended.



- (a) According to **Source 1**, what was the impact of enemy shelling on the GPO on Thursday?

S ✓ The heat from burning buildings near the GPO was so great that rebels had to drop defenses at the windows, like sandbags and sacks, in water to prevent them catching on fire.

- (b) According to **Source 1**, why did the Volunteers evacuate the GPO on Friday evening?

S ✓ The shells that had struck the GPO since noon had started so many fires that it would have been impossible to stay.

- (c) Is **Source 1** a primary source or a secondary source? Give a reason for your answer.

Primary or secondary:

Primary

Reason:

S ✓ It is an account from somebody who was there at the time and place of the event.

- (d) In relation to events at the GPO during the 1916 Rising, what are **two** ways in which the visual evidence from **Source 2** supports the written evidence in **Source 1**?

S ✓ You can see that the shells destroyed many buildings surrounding the GPO. You can also see that the GPO is charred from the fires caused by the shells.

e) Apart from the Rising, what else can Source 2 tell us about life in Dublin in 1916?

There are no tall buildings in the background, suggesting that Dublin had not developed much. All of the people inspecting the rubble are men, suggesting that women played the role of a housemaker, not doing jobs outside as much.

f) Name **two** leaders who signed the 1916 Proclamation of Independence.

1. Pádraig Pearse
2. Éamon de Valera

g) Explain **two** consequences of the 1916 Rising.

People were outraged when the leaders were executed by the British after the Rising. This made people support the idea of an independent Ireland even more. Many rebels were sent to prisons like Frongoch in Wales, where they developed their ideas and gained trust and connections among each other. Michael Collins also became more important in these universities of republicanism.

5/5
5/5

Section 3: Leader of the 1916 Rising

Write an account on the life of Patrick Pearse and his involvement in the 1916 Rising.

Patrick Pearse was born on Great Brunswick Street in Dublin, in 1879. His father was a stonemason. His mother spoke Irish, which gave him the love of the Irish language. He was the second eldest of four children. He was a good student in his private primary school, and later in the CBS on Westland Row.

In 1896, he joined the Gaelic League. It was a group that promoted Irish language and culture. He became the editor of their newspaper. In 1908, he set up the first bilingual school. It was called St. Enda's in Rathfarnham.

He joined the Irish Volunteers. They were an army set up by Eoin MacNeill to defend against possible Unionist attacks. By 1913, he got onto the committee, meaning he was one of their leaders. He participated in the Howth gun-running of 1914, which

attempted to bring arms and ammunition from Germany to Ireland. At this point, he wanted full Irish independence from Britain. He joined the IRB and began planning the rising.

He got onto the military council of the IRB the Fenians. They planned a rising in Dublin with the goal of achieving an independent Ireland. Pearse believed in blood sacrifice, the idea that Irish people would have to die for the freedom of their country. He signed the 1916 Proclamation.

On Easter Monday, 1916, the rising took place in Dublin. Pearse read the Proclamation aloud on the steps of the GPO. The rebels then captured the GPO, and Pearse directed operations from there. They captured many areas around Dublin, including the Four Courts, St. Stephen's Green, South Dublin Union, the Mendicity Institute, Boland's Mills and Jacob's Factory. By the end of the week, the rebels were in trouble. Pearse, unhappy with the amount of civilian deaths, surrendered. He was captured alongside 90 other leaders and sent to Kilmainham Gaol. He was executed by firing squad on the 3rd of May. He became an icon who inspired Irish people to fight for independence, and by 1923, the Irish Free State was established.